

LI, WENTAO (WINSTON)

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EDUCATION

The University of Texas Health Science Center at Houston *Feb 2021 - Dec 2025*
5th-year PhD student in the School of Biomedical Informatics

Awards: *Dean's Excellent Award, 2021; Jingchun Sun Memorial Scholarship of UTHealth, 2023; D.Bradley McWilliams Scholars Endowed Scholarship Award, 2024.*

University of California, San Diego *Sep 2018 - Jun 2020*
Master of Science in Statistics

Shanghai Maritime University, Shanghai, China *Sep 2014 - Jun 2018*
Bachelor of Science in Mathematics

SUMMARY

Ph.D. student with 5 years of experience in Medical/Cell Imaging, Privacy AI, and Foundation Modeling.

RESEARCH AND WORK EXPERIENCE

Tempus AI *June 2025 - August 2025*
Machine Learning Summer Associate - Cell Imaging

- Developed a cell-type prediction model with foundation models on Spatial Transcriptomic data (VisiumHD), which enhanced the accuracy of cell-type identification in cancer research.

The University of Texas MD Anderson Cancer Center *Oct 2023 - present*
Researcher - Medical Imaging

- Developed a novel cross-modal attention fusion method to enhance predictive modeling in cancer studies[1];
- Performed survival analysis on lung cancer patients in immunotherapy and chemotherapy[2];
- Investigated brain regional interactions and genetic variant expressions with a novel approach that incorporates individualized brain patterns in genomic association analysis.

The University of Texas Health Science Center at Houston *Jul 2020 - Sep 2023*
Research Assistant - Healthcare Privacy AI

- Developed COLLAGENE, a secure analysis tool offers a practical solution for privacy-preserving GWAS[3];
- Developed series of Federated Generalized Linear Mixed Models (FedGLMMs) for Genome-Wide Association Studies (GWAS)[4, 5];
- Developed a privacy-preserving federated learning method for cohort studies[6];
- Created a deep learning model to accurately predict blood pressure from photoplethysmogram (PPG) signals;
- Hosted federated training across Houston, San Diego, and Munich with VERTIGO-CI[7];

University of California, San Diego *Jun 2019 - Jun 2020*
Research Assistant - Clinical Prediction

- Conducted mathematical proofs for calibration measurements and models in clinical prediction research [8];

EXPERTISE HIGHLIGHTS

- Comprehensive experience and publications of developing AI and Deep Learning models in Medical and Cell Imaging, Genetic data, Clinical analysis, Cancer research, and Healthcare Privacy
- Strong coding skills with deep learning platforms (PyTorch and TensorFlow) in Python and R
- Proficient in Git for version control; Experienced in Docker for environment management; AWS and GCP

PROFESSIONAL PRESENTATIONS

International Symposium on Biomedical Imaging 2025

April 2025

Challenge Host

Workshop host and committee member of the Glioma-MDC 2025 challenge: Detection and classification of mitotic cells in glioma from digital pathological images. ([Link](#))

MICCAI 2024 CMMCA Workshop

Oct 2024

Principal Speaker

- Presentation on published conference paper *Attention-fusion Model for Multi-Omics (AMMO) Data Integration in Lung Adenocarcinoma*. (Recording, Poster)

AMIA 2021 Virtual Informatics Summit

Mar 2021

Principal Speaker

- Presentation on published conference paper *VERTical Grid lOgistic regression with Confidence Interval*.

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

 Google Scholar

- [1] **W. Li**, A. Muneer, M. Waqas, X. Zhou, and J. Wu, “Attention-fusion model for multi-omics (ammo) data integration in lung adenocarcinoma,” in *International Workshop on Computational Mathematics Modeling in Cancer Analysis*, pp. 52–60, Springer, 2024.
- [2] M. B. Saad, Q. Al-Tashi, L. Hong, **W. Li**, D. Boiarsky, S. Li, M. Petranovic, C. C. Wu, B. Carter, T. Cascone, *et al.*, “1236 machine learning-based clinico-genomic prediction of benefits to add chemotherapy to immunotherapy in metastatic non-small cell lung cancer,” 2024.
- [3] **W. Li**, M. Kim, K. Zhang, H. Chen, X. Jiang, and A. Harmanici, “COLLAGENE enables privacy-aware federated and collaborative genomic data analysis,” *Genome Biology*, vol. 24, no. 1, p. 204.
- [4] **W. Li**, H. Chen, X. Jiang, and A. Harmanici, “Federated generalized linear mixed models for collaborative genome-wide association studies,” *iScience*, vol. 26, no. 8, p. 107227.
- [5] **W. Li**, H. Chen, X. Jiang, and A. Harmanici, “Fedgmmat: Federated generalized linear mixed model association tests,” *PLoS computational biology*, vol. 20, no. 7, p. e1012142, 2024.
- [6] **W. Li**, J. Tong, M. M. Anjum, N. Mohammed, Y. Chen, and X. Jiang, “Federated learning algorithms for generalized mixed-effects model (GLMM) on horizontally partitioned data from distributed sources,” *BMC Medical Informatics and Decision Making*, vol. 22, no. 1, p. 269. Publisher: Springer.
- [7] **W. Li***, J. Kim*, T. Bath, X. Jiang, and L. Ohno-Machado, “VERTical grid lOgistic regression with confidence intervals (VERTIGO-CI),” *AMIA Summits on Translational Science Proceedings*, vol. 2021, p. 355. Publisher: American Medical Informatics Association.
- [8] Y. Huang, **W. Li**, F. Macheret, R. A. Gabriel, and L. Ohno-Machado, “A tutorial on calibration measurements and calibration models for clinical prediction models,” *Journal of the American Medical Informatics Association*, vol. 27, no. 4, pp. 621–633. Publisher: Oxford University Press.